

Question:

The surgical equipment used during a craniectomy is sterilized using pressurized steam at 121°C for 15 minutes. Reuse of these instruments can cause transmission of which of the following pathogens? Answer Choices: A. Non-enveloped viruses B. Enveloped viruses C. Yeasts D. Prions

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The assistant is thinking about the fact that craniectomy is a type of surgery that involves the removal of a portion of the skull, and that the surgical equipment used during this procedure is sterilized using pressurized steam. The assistant is also considering the fact that reuse of these instruments can cause the transmission of a variety of pathogens, such as bacteria, viruses, and fungi. The assistant is thinking about the fact that non-enveloped viruses, such as norovirus, are highly resistant to heat and can survive for long periods of time, even in the presence of steam. </think> <answer> A. Non-enveloped viruses </answer>

